# DCIT 208- SOFTWARE ENGINEERING

## D0: Team Charter, Client Intake, Repository Setup & AI Contract

| Team Name | Apex Unified (AU) |
|---|---|
| Project Title | HavenRae Project Management Platform |
| Client Name | HavenRae Studios (Contact: Angel Sharon) |
| Repository URL | https://github.com/RachelNhyira23/DCIT-208-GROUP-25 |
| Commit Hash / Tag | 0ab01d7 |
| Submission Date | 24th June, 2026 |
| AI Assistance Disclosure | AI (ChatGPT/Claude) was used to help draft and organize team documents (bios, agreements, templates); all content was reviewed, edited, and approved by the team. Full log in AI_USAGE.md |


**MEMBERS NAME:**

JEAN AFIBA GARIBAH

KWADWO ADUSEI FRIMPONG

ADJEPONG JESSE OFOSU

RACHEL NHYIRA ANANE-FRIMPONG

AARON ALLOTEY

ANAFO IMAN YELBA

ACQUAYE DARYL NII ADDO

## CONTENTS

## SECTION A: TEAM IDENTITY

**Team name:** Apex Unified

**Project working title:** HavenRae Project Management Platform

**Tagline:** Innovate, Build, Commit

### Team Member Details

| Name | Student ID | Email | Contact | GitHub Username |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Jean Afiba Garibah** | 22329791 | Jagaribah001@st.ug.edu.gh | 0537088915 | Afiba1 |
| **Kwadwo Adusei Frimpong** | 22378107 | kafrimpong032@st.ug.edu.gh | 0541793488 | kwadwofrimpong06 |
| **Adjepong Jesse Ofosu** | 22383156 | joadjepong001@st.ug.edu.gh | 0599579874 | joadjepong |
| **Rachel Nhyira Anane-Frimpong** | 22368253 | rnanane-frimpong001@st.ug.edu.gh | 0209220321 | RachelNhyira23 |
| **Anafo Iman Yelba** | 22330946 | iiyanafo@st.ug.edu.gh | 0559732220 | anafoyelba-blip |
| **Acquaye Daryl Nii Addo** | 22411960 | dnaacquaye@st.ug.edu.gh | 0549309637 | Daryl-ac |
| **Aaron Allotey** | 22268343 | aallotey010@st.ug.edu.gh | 0531376147 | aaronallotey14 |

# 1. MEMBER BIOGRAPHIES

## 1.1 JEAN AFIBA GARIBAH

Jean Afiba Garibah is an Information Technology student at the University of Ghana, Legon, pursuing the DCIT program with a focus on software engineering. As Product/Client Manager for her team's DCIT 208 client project, she leads client communication, requirements clarification, and coordination across a seven-person engineering team, ensuring deliverables stay aligned with real client needs. Afiba combines strong organizational skills with clear, direct communication, translating client conversations into actionable requirements and acceptance criteria. She is detail-oriented, dependable under deadlines, and skilled at keeping cross-functional teams accountable. She is eager to grow her experience in client-facing technology roles and product management.

## 1.2 KWADWO ADUSEI FRIMPONG

Kwadwo Adusei Frimpong is a level 200 BSc Information Technology student and an Architecture and Context Lead with a strong ability to design, organize, and maintain the technical foundation of software projects. He is responsible for creating system context, container, and component diagrams, developing data models, and defining API and interface contracts that ensure smooth communication between system components. Kwadwo also produces Architecture Decision Records (ADRs) and promotes consistency across the repository as new features are introduced. His analytical thinking, attention to detail, and leadership skills enable him to justify technical decisions clearly and guide teams in building reliable, scalable, and well-structured software solutions for organizational success.

## 1.3 ADJEPONG JESSE OFOSU

Adjepong Jesse, a BSc Information Technology student in level 200, is a detail-oriented QA and Validation Lead with hands-on expertise in end-to-end software quality assurance. Specializing in test strategy design, he architects comprehensive testing frameworks that span unit, integration, API, UI, and end-to-end testing, ensuring every release meets the highest standards. With a sharp focus on traceability, he maps test cases directly to requirements and user stories, maintains rigorous defect logs, and enforces structured Definitions of Done. Experienced in CI/CD pipeline validation and sprint-level quality reporting, he bridges the gap between development velocity and production reliability, making him an asset to any engineering team.

### 1.4 RACHEL NHYIRA ANANE-FRIMPONG

Rachel Nhyira Anane-Frimpong is a second-year Information Technology student with a strong interest in software engineering, DevOps, and problem-solving. She excels at identifying challenges, analyzing requirements, and developing practical solutions that improve system reliability and team productivity. As a DevOps and Release Lead, Rachel is experienced in managing GitHub repositories, maintaining CI/CD workflows, supporting deployments, and coordinating software releases. She enjoys collaborating with diverse teams, brainstorming innovative ideas, and transforming concepts into functional software solutions. With strong communication, organizational, and technical skills, Rachel is committed to continuous learning and delivering high-quality results in dynamic development environments.

### 1.5 ANAFO IMAN YELBA

Yelba Iman is a dedicated UX and Research Lead with a passion for creating user-centered digital experiences. She specializes in understanding user needs through observation, research, and workflow analysis, transforming insights into intuitive and accessible solutions. Yelba is skilled in developing user personas, mapping workflows, creating wireframes, and conducting usability testing to improve product effectiveness. With a strong focus on inclusive design and accessibility, she ensures that products are easy to use for diverse audiences. Her ability to bridge user needs with project goals helps teams deliver meaningful, efficient, and engaging digital experiences.

### 1.6 ACQUAYE DARYL NII ADDO

As an Implementation Lead, Daryl is a meticulous software developer who bridges the gap between system design and robust feature execution. Leveraging a strong foundation in version control and collaborative programming, he drives development through disciplined use of GitHub Issues, feature branching, and pull requests. Daryl is committed to maintaining high code quality by writing comprehensive tests alongside new features and actively engaging in rigorous peer code reviews. A strong technical communicator, he ensures all implementation decisions are thoroughly documented while strictly meeting project definitions of done. With a transparent and organized approach to modern development workflows, Daryl consistently delivers reliable, production-ready code.

### 1.7 AARON ALLOTEY

Aaron Allotey is a Level 200 BSc Information Technology student with a strong interest in organization, teamwork, and effective communication within project environments. As the Documentation/Evidence Lead, he is responsible for recording project activities, organizing supporting evidence, and ensuring that all documentation is accurate, clear, and professionally presented. He is detail-oriented, dependable, and committed to maintaining proper records that reflect the progress and quality of teamwork. Aaron enjoys using digital tools to improve efficiency and structure information effectively. He is eager to contribute his growing technical knowledge, organizational skills, and professionalism in environments that value accuracy and accountability.

## 2.1 TEAM PHOTO


## 2.2 PRIMARY & DEPUTY TEAM CONTACT

**Primary contact:** Jean Afiba Garbah- Product/Client Manager

**Deputy contact:** Rachel Nhyira Anane-Frimpong

## SECTION B: TEAM OPERATING AGREEMENT

### 1. COMMUNICATION TOOLS AND EXPECTED RESPONSE TIMES

- **Primary Communication Tool: WhatsApp Group**
  - **Description**: All general team announcements, quick coordination, daily updates, and urgent questions will be handled here. Every member must join and enable notifications.
- **Secondary/Formal Communication Tool: Email (Gmail/UG Email)**
  - **Description**: Used for formal communication with the client, sending meeting minutes, sharing finalized documents for review, and official correspondence with the lecturer.
- **Document Collaboration: Google Docs / Google Drive**
  - **Description**: All written deliverables (proposals, SRS, reports, etc.) will be drafted and collaboratively edited here. The Documentation/Evidence Lead will maintain the master versions.
- **Code & Project Management: GitHub Issues + GitHub Projects**
  - **Description:** Will be used as the single source of truth for all development tasks, sprint planning, bug tracking, and progress monitoring. Every task must be tracked as an issue.
- **Video Conferencing: Google Meet**
  - **Description:** Primary platform for all team meetings, client meetings, and architecture defense presentations.
- **Expected Response Times:**
  - General WhatsApp Messages: Expected response within 3 hours during 8:00 AM - 10:00 PM.
  - Critical/Emergency Messages: (e.g., "Sakai is down," "Client needs immediate feedback," "CI pipeline is failing") Expected response within 1 hour during working hours (8:00 AM - 8:00 PM).
  - Email Communication: Expected response within 12 hours (business days).

### 2. MEETING SCHEDULE, ATTENDANCE RULES, AND RECORD-KEEPING

- **Weekly Team Meetings:**
  - Meeting 1: Every Tuesday, from 3:00 PM - 6:00 PM via Google Meet.
  - Meeting 2: Every Friday, from 6:00 PM - 8:00 PM via Google Meet.
  - Total Weekly Meeting Time: 4 hours (2 hours per session).
  - Additional Sessions: In-person meetings may be scheduled for urgent issues, client demos, or before major deadlines.
- **Attendance Rules:**
  - Attendance is mandatory for all team members at both weekly sessions.
  - If a member cannot attend, they must:
    - Notify the team via the WhatsApp group at least 4 hours before the meeting.

        - Provide a valid reason (e.g., illness, family emergency, academic obligation).
        - Submit any assigned deliverables or updates to the Product/Client Manager before the meeting.
    - Three unexcused absences will trigger a formal warning and escalation to the course lecturer.
- **Meeting Agenda:**
    - The Product/Client Manager will prepare and share a brief meeting agenda on the WhatsApp group at least 12 hours before each scheduled meeting.
    - Agenda items will include: Sprint progress review, blockers, client feedback, task assignments, and upcoming deadlines.
- **Minutes-Taking Responsibility:**
    - Meeting minutes will be taken by a rotating note-taker, assigned alphabetically by name at the start of each sprint.
    - The rotating order will be: Afiba → Kwadwo→ Rachel → Daryl → Yelba→ Jesse → Aaron → repeat.
    - Minutes must include:
        - Date, time, and attendees.
        - Key discussion points.
        - Decisions made.
        - Action items with assigned owners and deadlines.
        - Open questions or blockers for the client/lecturer.
- **Decision-Recording Process:**
    - Minor Decisions: Recorded in meeting minutes and WhatsApp group for visibility.
    - Major Decisions (e.g., technology stack, architecture changes, scope changes, sprint re-prioritization):
        - Must be discussed during a full team meeting.
        - Requires consensus or a majority vote (minimum 5/7 members).
        - Must be documented in the meeting minutes.
        - Critical technical decisions must be recorded as an Architecture Decision Record (ADR) in the repository (as required by D4).

## 3. WORK DIVISION PROCESS AND REVIEW PROCEDURES

- **Task Creation:**
  Tasks are created as GitHub Issues with labels (feature, bug, docs, testing, security, ai-assisted). Each issue includes a clear title/description, acceptance criteria, priority (Must/Should/Could/Won't), Fibonacci story points (1, 2, 3, 5, 8), and a link to the relevant requirement or user story.
- **Task Assignment:**
  During Tuesday sprint planning, the Product/Client Manager and Implementation Leads assign tasks based on each member's role, workload balance, and skill set. Every task has a single, named owner.
- **Development Workflow:**
- Owner picks a task → creates a branch (feature/issue-<XX>-<short-description>) → implements and tests locally → opens a PR linked to the issue → gets reviewed by a non-author teammate → addresses feedback → passes CI (lint/test/build) → merges once approved
- **Code Review Expectations:**
  Every PR needs at least one approval from a non-author reviewer to check code quality, test coverage, security/privacy, and AI-assistance disclosure. Comments must be substantive ("LGTM" alone isn't acceptable), and all conversations must be resolved before merging.
- **Task Acceptance Criteria:**
  An issue moves to "Done" only once all acceptance criteria are met, tests pass, evidence (screenshots/links) is attached for UI changes, and the QA/Validation Lead verifies it.

## 5. CONFLICT-RESOLUTION RULES AND CONSEQUENCES

- Conflict Resolution Process:
  1. Direct Communication: Team members in conflict will first attempt to resolve the issue privately and professionally, focusing on the project, not personalities.
  2. Mediation: If direct communication fails, the Product/Client Manager and Architecture and Context Lead will mediate a discussion during a team meeting to find a compromise.
  3. Escalation: If a resolution is still impossible, the issue will be escalated to the course lecturer with a summary of the problem and attempts made to resolve it.
- Consequences for Non-Participation and Unprofessional Behavior:
  - Missed Meeting (Unexcused): Warning issued by the Product/Client Manager. Documented in meeting minutes.
  - Two Unexcused Absences: Team discussion during a meeting. The member is assigned additional documentation or review tasks to compensate.
  - Three Unexcused Absences: Reported to the course lecturer and may result in zero individual credit for project work.

    - Ghosting (No communication for 48 hours): Product/Client Manager sends a private message. If there is no response within 24 hours, the issue is escalated to the lecturer.
    - Submitting Low-Quality or Incomplete Work: The reviewer will reject the PR and request improvements. Repeated poor submissions will be escalated to the QA/Validation Lead and discussed in the team meeting.
    - Academic Dishonesty (Plagiarism, Fabricated Client Data, Undisclosed AI Use):
        - Immediate report to the course lecturer.
        - The member may receive zero individual credit for the project.
        - The rest of the team will continue, but the incident will be documented in the final post-mortem.
- Late Work Policy:
    - Course Deadline: All deliverables must be submitted by 5:00 PM Ghana time / Sakai server time on the due date, per the course policy.
    - Internal Freeze: 4:00 PM (1 hour before the deadline) – No new commits or document changes after this time. The final version ready for submission must be locked.
    - Late Submission: If a team member causes a submission to be late due to negligence, they will be held responsible and may receive reduced marks for that deliverable

## SUBMISSION PROCESS

Afiba (Product/Client Manager) prepares and submits the final PDF to Sakai, ensuring correct file naming, all required cover elements (team name, project title, client name, repo URL, commit hash, member list, AI disclosure), and that the editable source plus supporting evidence are pushed to docs/00_team_charter.

Aaron (Documentation/Evidence Lead) reviews the completed deliverable before submission, checking for formatting consistency, completeness against the deliverable checklist, and the absence of raw prompt dumps or placeholder text.

The team's internal submission freeze is 3:00 pm on the due date,  two hours ahead of the official 5:00 pm deadline or even earlier, giving time to fix last-minute issues, confirm the Sakai upload succeeded, and verify the GitHub push went through before the real cutoff.

## SECTION C: CLIENT AND PROBLEM INTAKE

**Client name**: HavenRae Studios

**Contact person & role:** Angel Sharon (Operations Manager)

### 1. INITIAL CLIENT PROBLEM STATEMENT

HavenRae Studios is an interior design company specializing in furnishing and styling residential rental units. As the company continues to grow and manage multiple projects simultaneously, operational processes have become increasingly difficult to coordinate efficiently. Currently, project information, schedules, budgets, supplier details, and task tracking are managed manually across various platforms, resulting in fragmented information and reduced productivity.

According to the Operations Manager, Angel Sharon, the company faces challenges in monitoring the progress of multiple units, organizing project timelines, tracking furniture and décor procurement, managing project budgets, and ensuring deadlines are met. The absence of a centralized system makes it difficult to obtain real-time updates on project status and prioritize tasks effectively.

The proposed software solution aims to provide a centralized project management platform that will streamline project scheduling, task management, budget tracking, supplier management, and project documentation. The system will enable better coordination across projects, improve visibility into ongoing operations, reduce administrative workload, and support the company's continued growth by ensuring projects are completed efficiently and on schedule.

### 2. EVIDENCE OF FIRST CONTACT

**Request for Collaboration on Software Solution Development.**

GJ
GARIBAH JEAN AFIBA
To r ira.havenrae@gmail.com
Yesterday

Dear Ms. Sharon,

I hope this email finds you well.

My name is Ms. Afiba Garibah, and I am writing on behalf of Apex Unified, a software development team undertaking a Software Engineering project as part of our academic program.

We recently learned about the operations of HavenRae Studios and understand that managing multiple interior design projects, schedules, budgets, supplier information, and project documentation can be challenging as the business continues to grow. We believe there is an opportunity to develop a software solution that could help streamline these processes and improve operational efficiency.

As part of our project, we are seeking to collaborate with a client organization to better understand their challenges and design a system that addresses their specific needs. We would be grateful for the opportunity to engage with HavenRae Studios and gather information about your current workflow, operational challenges, and desired system features.

Should you be interested, we would appreciate arranging a brief meeting or discussion at your convenience to explore the possibility of working together on this project.

Thank you for your time and consideration. We look forward to hearing from you.

Kind regards,

Apex Unified
Software Engineering Project Team
University of Ghana
+233 53 708 8915

## 3. INITIAL USER GROUPS

**Operations Manager**
Oversees projects, schedules, deadlines, and resources.

**Interior Designers**
View project requirements, update progress, upload design documents, and track tasks.

**Procurement/Sourcing Personnel**
Manage furniture, décor purchases, suppliers, and delivery schedules.

**Project Assistants**
Update task status, record project information, and assist with coordination.

**Management/Business Owner**

Monitor project progress, budgets, performance metrics, and reports.

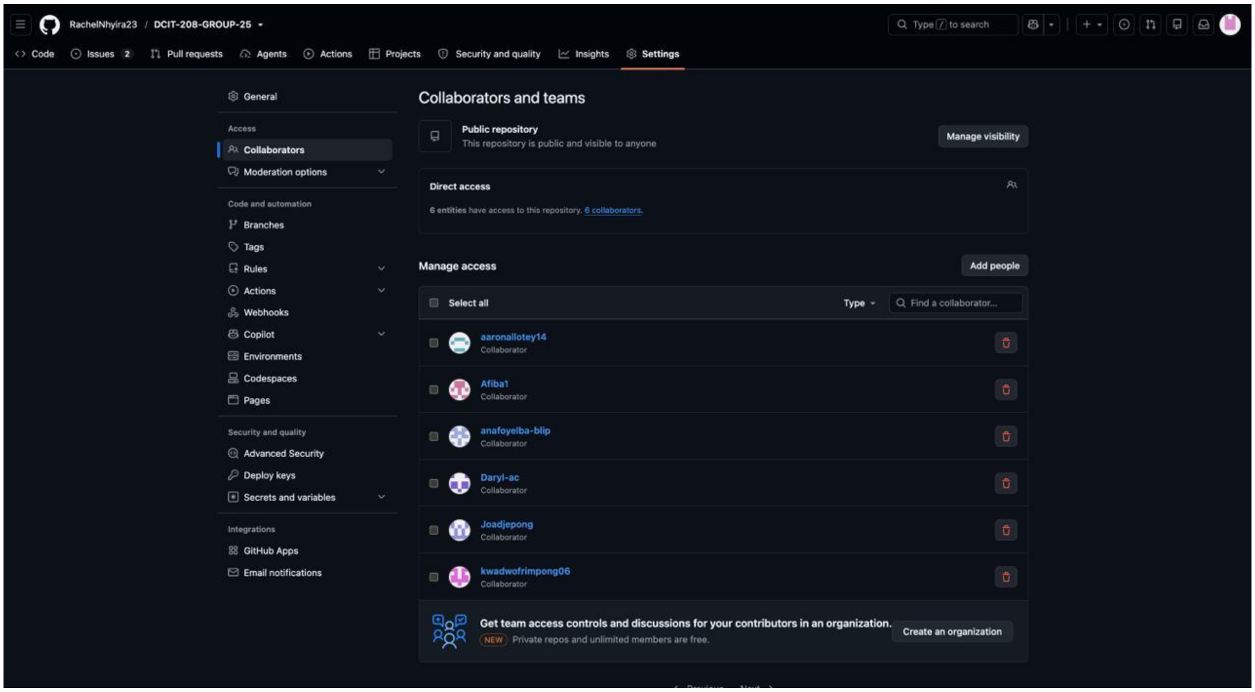
**Clients (Optional)**
View project updates, timelines, and approved designs.

## 4. FALLBACK PLAN

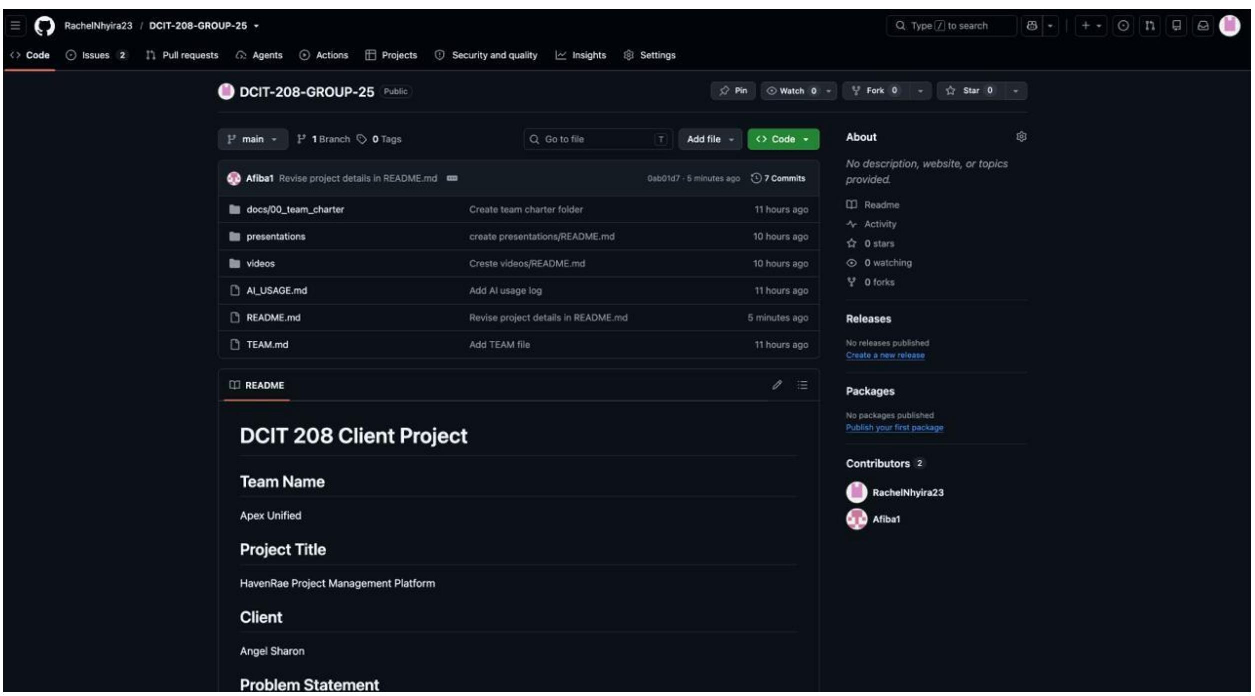
If HavenRae Studios becomes unavailable before the next project milestone, Apex Unified will engage a secondary client from the interior design, event planning, or small business sector with similar project management and scheduling requirements. The existing requirements gathered from HavenRae Studios will be adapted to the new client's operational needs with minimal changes to the proposed system architecture.

## SECTION D: REPOSITORY AND PLATFORM SETUP

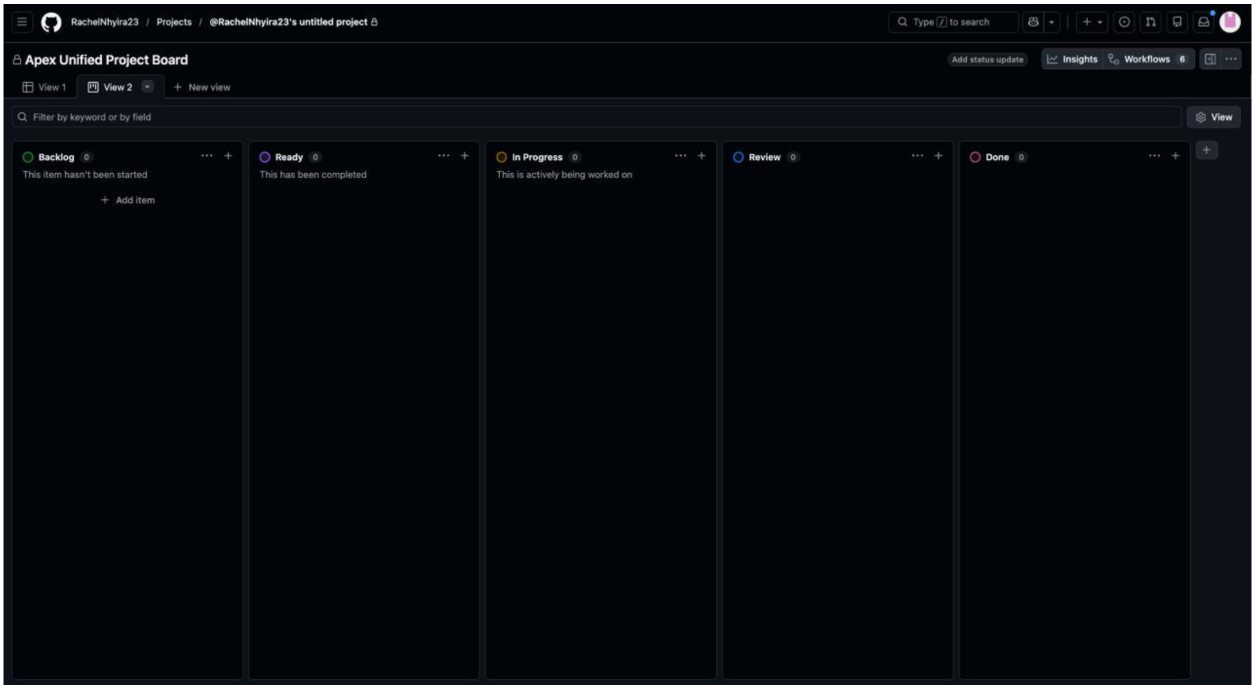
**GitHub Classroom repository link:** github.com/RachelNhyira23/DCIT-208-GROUP-25




## REPOSITORY INITIALIZATION PROOF



## PROJECT BOARD




**Team YouTube channel name**: ApexUnified_1
**Team YouTube channel URL:** https://www.youtube.com/@ApexUnified_1
**Sakai group submission contact**: Jean Afiba Garibah-22329791

## SECTION E: AI CONTRACT

By signing below, each team member acknowledges and agrees to the following:

# Team AI Contract For Software Engineering– SEG26-25-AU (Apex Unified)

We as a team agree that AI tools such as ChatGPT, GitHub Copilot, and Gemini may be used to assist with brainstorming, debugging, documentation, and learning concepts. AI may not be used to submit work that a team member does not understand.

## Team Communication

- Primary communication tool: WhatsApp Group
- Repository and task management: GitHub Classroom and GitHub Issues
- Weekly meeting: Tuesdays at 6:00 PM (Google Meet/Microsoft Teams)
- Emergency meetings may be called by the team leader with at least 2 hours' notice.

## AI Usage Rules

- Every use of AI must be recorded in AI_USAGE.md.
- The entry must include:
  - Date
  - AI tool used
  - Purpose
  - What was accepted, modified, or rejected

## Security Rules

- No team member may paste passwords, API keys, student records, lecturer information, or confidential project data into public AI tools.
- Code containing sensitive information must be reviewed by at least one other team member before being pushed to GitHub.

## Response-Time Rules

- Team members should respond to messages within 3 hours.
- Urgent project messages should receive a response within 2 hours.
- If a member will be unavailable for more than 24 hours, they must notify the group beforehand.

## Understanding and Accountability

- Every member must be able to explain any code, documentation, diagrams, or presentations they submit.
- During reviews, another team member may ask for an explanation of contributed work.

- Any member who cannot explain their contribution may lose credit for that specific work.

## Agreement

By signing below, each team member agrees to follow this contract throughout the project.

Signatures:

1. Jean Afba Garbah
2. Kwadwo Adusei Frimpong
3. Jesse Obosu Adjepong
4. Rachel Shyircs Anane Frimpong
5. Acquaye Daryl Nii Addo
6. Aaron Klloteу
7. Anafo Iman Yelba